



Oral Cavity, Palate & Salivary Glands — MCQ Practice

Anatomy GIT Block · MEDucation by Mattin Majid

HOW TO USE THIS SET

20 questions, 5 options each (A-E). Answer on paper or in your head, then check every answer against the key on the final page.

4 Easy · 10 Medium · 6 Hard · suggested time ≈ 25 minutes.

Q Questions

1. What is the main muscle of the cheek, forming the lateral wall of the oral cavity?

EASY

- A. Orbicularis oris
- B. Buccinator
- C. Masseter
- D. Mylohyoid
- E. Platysma

2. How many teeth are there in the primary (deciduous) dentition?

EASY

- A. 32
- B. 28
- C. 24
- D. 20
- E. 16

3. Which is the largest major salivary gland?

EASY

- A. Parotid
- B. Submandibular
- C. Sublingual
- D. Minor labial
- E. Von Ebner's

4. Which structure separates the anterior two-thirds of the tongue from the posterior one-third?

EASY

- A. Lingual frenulum
- B. Median sulcus
- C. Sulcus terminalis
- D. Palatoglossal fold
- E. Sublingual fold

5. After a dental injection a patient has numbness of the upper lip, but can still purse his lips normally. Which nerve was blocked?

MEDIUM

- A. Mental nerve (V3)
- B. Facial nerve (CN VII)
- C. Buccal nerve (V3)
- D. Lingual nerve (V3)
- E. Infraorbital nerve (V2)

6. A patient with a right hypoglossal nerve lesion is examined. Which extrinsic tongue muscle is spared?

MEDIUM

- A. Palatoglossus
- B. Genioglossus
- C. Hyoglossus
- D. Styloglossus
- E. Inferior longitudinal

7. A lesion of the mandibular nerve (V3) paralyses one muscle of the soft palate. Which one?

MEDIUM

- A. Levator veli palatini
- B. Palatopharyngeus
- C. Tensor veli palatini
- D. Musculus uvulae
- E. Palatoglossus

8. A dentist wants to see saliva flowing from the parotid duct. Where should he look?

MEDIUM

- A. On the sublingual caruncle beside the lingual frenulum
- B. In the vestibule opposite the upper (maxillary) second molar
- C. Along the sublingual fold
- D. On the hard palate behind the incisors
- E. Opposite the lower first molar

9. A stone obstructs a duct that opens onto the sublingual caruncle at the base of the lingual frenulum. Which gland will swell?

MEDIUM

- A. Parotid
- B. Sublingual
- C. Minor palatine glands
- D. Submandibular
- E. Lacrimal

10. A patient has lost taste over the anterior two-thirds of the tongue, but touch sensation there is normal. Which nerve is damaged?

MEDIUM

- A. Lingual nerve (V3) proper
- B. Glossopharyngeal nerve
- C. Hypoglossal nerve
- D. Internal laryngeal nerve
- E. Chorda tympani (CN VII)

11. A squamous carcinoma at the tip of the tongue spreads by lymphatics. Which node group is most likely to be involved first?

MEDIUM

- A. Submental nodes
- B. Submandibular nodes
- C. Pre-auricular nodes
- D. Parotid nodes
- E. Occipital nodes

12. Which statement correctly describes the sublingual gland?

MEDIUM

- A. It is serous and enclosed in a tough fascial sheath
- B. It lies below the mylohyoid in the submandibular triangle
- C. It is the smallest major gland, mainly mucous, and lacks a true capsule
- D. It produces most of the resting saliva
- E. It drains through a single duct to the vestibule

13. A surgeon removing the submandibular gland finds an artery looping over its superior and posterior borders. Which artery is it?

MEDIUM

- A. Lingual artery
- B. Maxillary artery
- C. Superficial temporal artery
- D. Facial artery
- E. Transverse facial artery

14. During a parotidectomy, which structures emerge from beneath the anterior border of the gland and must be preserved?

MEDIUM

- A. Lingual nerve and Wharton's duct
- B. Branches of the facial nerve and the parotid duct
- C. Great auricular nerve and external jugular vein
- D. Internal carotid artery and CN IX
- E. Chorda tympani and otic ganglion

15. A patient has a dry mouth only on one side after damage to the otic ganglion. Which pathway has been interrupted?

HARD

- A. Superior salivatory nucleus → CN VII → chorda tympani → lingual nerve → submandibular gland
- B. Superior cervical ganglion → periarterial plexus → parotid
- C. Inferior salivatory nucleus → CN X → pharyngeal plexus → parotid
- D. Superior salivatory nucleus → CN IX → otic ganglion → sublingual gland
- E. Inferior salivatory nucleus → CN IX → otic ganglion → auriculotemporal nerve → parotid

16. The chorda tympani is cut during middle-ear surgery. Which combination of deficits is expected?

HARD

- A. Reduced submandibular and sublingual secretion, and loss of taste from the anterior two-thirds of the tongue
- B. Reduced parotid secretion and loss of taste from the posterior third
- C. Paralysis of palatoglossus and dry mouth
- D. Loss of touch on the anterior two-thirds and reduced parotid secretion
- E. Paralysis of buccinator and dry eye

17. A deep lobe parotid tumour extends through the posteromedial surface. Which structures is it most likely to meet?

HARD

- A. Masseter and medial pterygoid
- B. Platysma and great auricular nerve
- C. Parotid duct and buccinator
- D. Styloid process and its muscles, with the ICA, IJV and CN IX-XII deep to them
- E. Mylohyoid and hyoglossus

18. A student is asked which statement about the tongue is FALSE.

HARD

- A. Intrinsic muscles change the shape of the tongue
- B. Extrinsic muscles move the tongue
- C. All tongue muscles, including palatoglossus, are supplied by the hypoglossal nerve
- D. The foramen cecum is a remnant of the thyroglossal duct
- E. The central tongue has bilateral lymphatic drainage to the deep cervical nodes

19. An anxious student notices that his saliva becomes thick and scanty. Which description of the responsible innervation is correct?

HARD

- A. Parasympathetic from the inferior salivatory nucleus via the otic ganglion
- B. Parasympathetic via the chorda tympani
- C. Somatic motor from the hypoglossal nerve
- D. Hormonal control via gastrin
- E. Sympathetic from the superior cervical ganglion via periarterial plexuses, reducing blood flow

20. A patient has swelling in the floor of the mouth above the mylohyoid, raising the sublingual fold. Medially the swelling lies against a large tongue muscle and a nerve. What are they?

- A.** Hyoglossus and hypoglossal nerve
- B.** Genioglossus and lingual nerve
- C.** Styloglossus and glossopharyngeal nerve
- D.** Mylohyoid and nerve to mylohyoid
- E.** Palatoglossus and vagus nerve

✓ Answer key

Q	Answer	Difficulty	Why
1	B	EASY	The buccinator compresses the cheek against the teeth and helps with mastication, sucking and blowing. Orbicularis oris is the main muscle of the lips.
2	D	EASY	The deciduous dentition has 20 teeth, with no premolars and no third molars. The adult permanent dentition has 32.
3	A	EASY	The parotid is the largest major salivary gland: serous, enclosed in the parotid sheath and lying in the retromandibular fossa.
4	C	EASY	The sulcus terminalis separates the oral part (anterior 2/3) from the oropharyngeal part (posterior 1/3). The foramen cecum lies at its apex.
5	E	MEDIUM	Upper lip sensation is from the infraorbital nerve (V2). Lip movement is by the facial nerve (orbicularis oris), which is intact.
6	A	MEDIUM	All tongue muscles are supplied by CN XII except palatoglossus, which is supplied by the vagus (CN X).
7	C	MEDIUM	Most soft-palate muscles are supplied by the vagus through the pharyngeal plexus. The exception is tensor veli palatini (V3), which also forms most of the palatine aponeurosis.
8	B	MEDIUM	The parotid duct crosses the masseter, turns medially, pierces the buccinator and opens into the vestibule opposite the upper second molar.
9	D	MEDIUM	Wharton's (submandibular) duct opens on the sublingual caruncle. The sublingual gland drains through 8-20 ducts of Rivinus along the sublingual fold.
10	E	MEDIUM	The slide's tongue figure shows taste from the anterior 2/3 by the chorda tympani (CN VII) and general sensation by the lingual nerve (V3).
11	A	MEDIUM	The tip of the tongue drains mainly to the submental nodes; the lateral anterior tongue to the submandibular nodes; the central tongue bilaterally to the deep cervical nodes.
12	C	MEDIUM	The sublingual gland is the smallest major gland, mainly mucous, with no true capsule. It lies above the mylohyoid and raises the sublingual fold.
13	D	MEDIUM	The facial artery loops over the superior and posterior borders of the submandibular gland. The lingual and hypoglossal nerves pass deep to it.
14	B	MEDIUM	The branches of the facial nerve (CN VII) and Stensen's duct emerge from or cross the anterior border of the parotid, on its anteromedial surface.
15	E	HARD	The parotid's secretomotor supply runs from the inferior salivatory nucleus via CN IX to the otic ganglion, then with the auriculotemporal nerve (V3) to the gland.
16	A	HARD	The chorda tympani carries secretomotor fibres (superior salivatory nucleus → lingual nerve → submandibular ganglion) and, per the tongue figure, taste from the anterior two-thirds.
17	D	HARD	The posteromedial surface rests on SCM, the posterior belly of digastric and the styloid process with its muscles, and is closely related to the ICA, IJV and the last four cranial nerves.
18	C	HARD	Palatoglossus is the exception: it is supplied by the vagus (CN X). All the other statements are true.
19	E	HARD	Sympathetic fibres from the superior cervical ganglion travel with the arteries, reduce blood flow and produce thick, viscous secretions.
20	B	HARD	The sublingual gland is related medially to the genioglossus and the lingual nerve, and laterally to the sublingual fossa of the mandible.